



The man who tried to eat every animal on Earth

【BBC精选：饕餮地质学家的狂想人生：吃遍万物、发现巨齿龙、破解地球密码】

Summary: In the 1830s, renowned British scientist William Buckland hosted unconventional dinners featuring exotic animals like mice and crocodile. As Oxford's first geology professor, he conducted groundbreaking fossil research while maintaining unorthodox teaching methods. Buckland's investigation of hyena caves challenged biblical timelines, and he published the first scientific account of a dinosaur. His wife Mary contributed significantly as a scientific illustrator. Despite failing to eat every animal species, Buckland demonstrated that science could be both revolutionary and entertaining.

摘要： 19世纪30年代，英国科学家威廉·巴克兰以老鼠和鳄鱼等异国食材举办奇特宴会。作为牛津大学首位地质学教授，他在开创性化石研究的同时保持着非常规的教学方式。通过对鬣狗洞穴的研究，他质疑了圣经的时间线，并发表了首份恐龙科学报告。其妻子玛丽作为科学插画家贡献卓著。尽管未能尝遍所有动物，巴克兰证明了科学既具革命性又充满趣味。





🕒 Estimated Reading Time: 6 min.

📖 四级生词 📖 六级生词 📖 雅思生词 📖 托福生词 📖 专八生词 📖 SAT生词 📖 考研生词 📖 GRE生词

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▶ It's the 1830s and you're invited to dinner at the home of one of Britain's most celebrated scientists

这是19世纪30年代，你受邀前往英国最#著名#的科学家之一家中赴宴

▶ You take the only chair that isn't piled high with books rocks and fossils

你坐上唯一没有被书籍、岩石和化石堆满的椅子

▶ Ralkers children are eager to show you their pets

沃克的孩子们#急切#地想向你展示他们的宠物

▶ Yeah, it's a dusty cocktail of smells

是啊 这是各种气味混合的尘味#鸡尾酒#

▶ But at last dinner arrives

但晚餐终于上桌

▶ Is it roast turkey?

是#烤#火鸡吗?

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▶ Mutton ham?

#羊肉# #火腿#?

▶ No, it's mouse on toast

不 是吐司#烤#鼠肉

▶ Your host is William Buckland and he's a zoer phage

你的主人是威廉·巴克兰 他是位动物噬食者

▶ Someone with a passion for eating one of every animal on earth

对品尝地球上所有动物怀有#热情#的人

▶ Mouse is just the starter

老鼠只是开胃菜

▶ Buckland was born in 1784 and became the first person ever to take geology

巴克兰生于1784年 成为牛津大学首位攻读#地质学#的人

▶ The study of the origin history and structure of the earth at the University of Oxford

这门学科研究地球的起源、历史与结构

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▶ He was then ordained as a priest before becoming a reader in mineralogy

他被任命为牧师 后成为矿物学讲师

▶ giving popular if unorthodox lectures

举办受欢迎但#非传统#的讲座

▶ A student record him sweeping down the front row one morning holding a hyena skull

有学生记录某天早晨他拿着鬣狗#头骨# #扫视#前排

▶ He picked out an undergraduate and demanded what rules the world

他挑出一位#本科生# 质问什么主宰世界

▶ Haven't an idea the student replied

学生回答不知道

▶ the stomach sir bellowed Buckland

肠胃 先生 巴克兰吼道

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▶ the stomach rules the world

肠胃主宰世界

▶ And Buckland lived by this rule

巴克兰奉行这一准则

▶ Dinner at the Buckland House could consist of Kejog crocodile pantha Cislog Corpus mole and even earwig

巴克兰家的晚餐可能包含鳄鱼、豹子、#鼯鼠#、鼯鼠甚至蠼螋

▶ and life was no less extraordinary between meals

餐间生活同样精彩

▶ William and his wife Mary taught their children natural history in a house packed to the rafters with specimens

威廉与妻子玛丽在堆满标本的房子里教孩子们自然史

🎧 Animal vegetable and mineral living and dead

动植物与矿物 生死俱存

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🎧 When they weren't riding ponies through the dining room or playing with snakes and frogs the children took part in their parents scientific studies

当不在餐厅骑小马或玩蛇蛙时 孩子们就参与父母的科研

🎧 One particularly wacky experiment involved spreading pie pastry over the kitchen table and allowing a pet tortoise to walk across it

有个特别古怪的实验：将馅饼皮铺满厨房桌面 让宠物龟爬行其上

🎧 The family then compared the tracks to fossilised tortoise prints found in ancient sandstone

全家将足迹与古代砂岩中的龟类化石脚印对比

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🎧 the tracks were identical

足迹#完全一致#

🎧 Besides eating fossils were the Buckland's passion

除饮食外 化石是巴克兰家族的#热情#所在

🎧 As a religious man William believed that the great flood mentioned in Genesis was not just a story but historical fact

作为信徒 威廉相信《创世纪》记载的大洪水不仅是故事更是史实

🎧 And he spent a long time trying to reconcile the bible's accounts with geological evidence

他长期试图#调和#圣经记载与地质证据

🎧 However after examining the remains of exotic creatures including hyenas found in a cave in North Yorkshire

但在检验北约克郡#洞穴#发现的鬣狗等#异域#生物遗骸后

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▶ He started to question the bible's timeline

他开始质疑圣经的时间线

▶ these animals had not as some are passionately been washed there from their tropical homes by Noah's flood

这些动物并非如某些人坚信的那样是被诺亚洪水从热带家园冲来

▶ they'd actually lived there

它们实际曾在此生活

▶ And the passage of geological time had since turned the British Isles from a tropical to a temperate landscape

地质时序已将不列颠群岛从热带变为温带景观

▶ William proved this by identifying large amounts of hyena dung on the cave floor

威廉通过识别#洞穴#地面大量鬣狗粪便证实此点

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▶ And time helped explain another mystery of the era

时间还帮助解释了当时的另一个谜团

▶ Dinosaurs

恐龙

▶ in 1824 Buckland announced arguably his greatest breakthrough of all the fossilised bones of a giant reptile

1824年巴克兰宣布了 arguably他最大的#突破#：一种巨型#爬行动物#的化石骨骼

▶ He named Megalosaurus found in a slate quarry in Oxfordshire

他将其命名为斑龙 发现于牛津郡的#板岩# #采石场#

▶ It was the first scientific account of a dinosaur

这是对#恐龙#的首个科学论述

▶ He showed them to French anatomist Georges Cuvier who noticed the bone similarity with living lizards

他将化石展示给法国解剖学家乔治·居维叶 对方注意到骨骼与现存蜥蜴的#相似性#

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▶ Buckland Cuvier and others worked was vital in helping Victorian Britain understand dinosaurs and their place in evolution

巴克兰、居维叶等人的工作至关重要 帮助维多利亚时期的英国理解恐龙及其在#进化#中的位置

▶ Williams' wife Mary was a keen geologist and a collector in her own right

威廉的妻子玛丽本身就是位热衷地质学的收藏家

▶ She illustrated those game-changing hyena bones for the royal society and produced beautiful teaching aids for Williams lectures

她为皇家学会绘制了那些颠覆性的鬣狗骨骼图 并为威廉的讲座制作精美教具#

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▶ Like many wives of scientists in the 19th century she may have done much more than that

如同19世纪许多科学家的妻子 她的贡献可能远不止于此

▶ perhaps contributing to some of Williams' major works

或许参与了威廉某些重要著作的创作

▶ As for Williams' quest to eat the world's animals

至于威廉吃遍全球动物的#追求#

▶ Well, he failed to complete the challenge despite his best efforts

尽管竭尽全力 他仍未完成挑战

▶ After a period of illness on related to his diet he died in 1856

经历一段与饮食相关的疾病后 他于1856年去世

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 Accenture as they were the Bucklands remind us that science can happen anywhere

巴克兰一家虽行事乖张 却提醒我们科学无处不在

 Including at home and that great science can also be great fun

包括家中 且伟大的科学也能充满乐趣

 as long as you're not a mouse

只要你不是老鼠

